



ANCIENT AI?

Trace the earliest references to the existence of artificial intelligence

Although the term “Artificial Intelligence” or AI is relatively new, the concept of non-human, artificially made creatures exhibiting human intelligence and emotions can hardly be called new. It can be traced back to mythological tales.

The earliest one being a love story from ancient times, purportedly written by the North African, Philostephanus about 2,300 years ago. His original story is rumoured to be the basis for Ovid’s famous tale, re-written about 2,000 years ago as Pygmalion and the statue. According to the story, Pygmalion was a Cypriot sculptor who carved a statue of a beautiful woman out of ivory, and then fell in love with her. His love and desire was so strong that his pleas to the goddess Venus were answered, and she came to life.